

DAY 0 — May 20 (Arrival → Canyon Base)	Time	Activity	Drive Time	Notes
	11:03 AM	Land in Bozeman	—	Get rental fast
	11:45 AM	Depart airport	—	Grab snacks before leaving
	11:45–3:00 PM	Drive to Canyon via North Entrance	~3–3.5 hrs	Includes buffers + traffic
	1:30 PM	Pass Mammoth Hot Springs	—	Optional 20–30 min stop
	3:00–4:00 PM	Arrive Canyon Lodge	—	Check-in
	Evening	Light walk / rest	—	Don't push
DAY 1 — May 21 (Lamar Valley — Wildlife Focus)	Time	Activity	Drive Time	Notes
	6:30 AM	Depart Canyon	—	Earlier = better wildlife
	6:30–7:45 AM	Drive to Lamar Valley	~1 hr 15 min	Scenic drive
	7:45–10:30 AM	Wildlife viewing	—	Core experience
	10:30–11:15 AM	Stop at Tower Fall	~20 min detour	Quick stop
	11:15–12:30 PM	Drive back to Canyon	~1–1.25 hr	
	Afternoon	Rest / nap / free time	—	Critical recovery
	5:30–7:00 PM	Optional short outing nearby	~20–30 min	Keep it light
DAY 2 — May 22 (Grand Canyon + Hayden Sunset)	Time	Activity	Drive Time	Notes
	8:00 AM	Start	—	Easy day
	8:15–10:30 AM	Grand Canyon of the Yellowstone	~15 min	Artist Point + Lower Falls
	10:30–12:00 PM	Short trail / explore	—	Add immersion
	12:00–2:00 PM	Lunch + rest at lodge	—	Avoid peak crowds
	5:30 PM	Depart for Hayden	—	Golden hour timing
	5:30–6:00 PM	Drive to Hayden Valley	~30 min	
	6:00–8:00 PM	Wildlife + sunset	—	High ROI
	8:00–8:30 PM	Return	~30 min	
DAY 3 — May 23 (Geyser Loop —	Time	Activity	Drive Time	Notes
	7:00 AM	Depart Canyon	—	Beat crowds
	7:00–8:30 AM	Drive south	~1.5 hr	
	8:30–10:00 AM	Old Faithful	—	Check eruption timing
	10:15–11:30 AM	Grand Prismatic Spring (overlook)	~20 min	Do overlook trail

Loop — Optimized)	11:30–12:30 PM	Optional basin (Biscuit/Fountain)	—	Only if energy allows
	12:30–2:00 PM	Lunch / break	—	
	2:00–3:30 PM	Return to Canyon	~1.5 hr	
	Evening	Rest	—	Needed
DAY 4 — May 24 (Norris + Lake — Balanced Day)	Time	Activity	Drive Time	Notes
	8:30 AM	Depart	—	Slightly relaxed start
	8:30–9:15 AM	Drive to Norris Geyser Basin	~45 min	
	9:15–11:00 AM	Explore Norris	—	Unique geology
	11:00–12:00 PM	Return toward Canyon	~45 min	
	12:00–2:00 PM	Rest / lunch	—	
	3:30–4:15 PM	Drive to Yellowstone Lake	~45 min	
	4:15–5:30 PM	Relax by lake	—	Low effort, high value
	Evening	Pack / chill	—	
DAY 5 — May 25 (Exit)	Time	Activity	Drive Time	Notes
	8:30 AM	Depart Canyon	—	Don't cut it close
	8:30–11:00 AM	Drive to Bozeman	~2–2.5 hrs	Buffer included
	11:00 AM	Return car	—	
	1:57 PM	Flight departure	—	Safe margin